UNIVERSITY OF SINDH

JAMSHORO SINDH, PAKISTAN

FACULTY OF EDUCATION ,UNIVERSITY OF SINDH

Title of Course: **Teaching Profession**
Course No.: EFMP-302 **Credit Hours: 3 (3-0)**
Major: Professional Course- II **Semester: 1st** **Class:B.Ed. (4 year)**

Course Description:

Being an effective and competent professional teacher in the 21st century is both a challenging and transformative endeavor. The increasing demands and expectations of society and multiple stakeholders have redefined the traditional roles and responsibilities of teachers at local and global levels. This course equips prospective teachers with a comprehensive understanding of the teaching profession as a dynamic, yet ethical and evolving field of practice. Student teachers will explore key dimensions of teacher professionalism, including professional ethics, codes of conduct, national and global professional standards, emotional regulation, and strategies for continuous professional development to manage the inherent and emerging complexities of teaching. Through the integration of theory, case analysis, reflective practice, and collaborative inquiry projects, the course enables prospective teachers to internalize the core teaching values, and lifelong learning mindset that define true professionalism in teaching.

Course Learning Outcomes:

By the end of the course, student teachers will be able to:

- Define and explain the role and responsibilities of teachers in education.
- Identify and exhibit the characteristics and qualities of an effective teacher.
- Analyze the importance of teacher professionalism and accountability.
- Develop skills to plan, implement, and evaluate teaching strategies for diverse learners.
- Evaluate the impact of teacher effectiveness on student learning outcomes.
- Demonstrate professional ethics in teaching, learning and assessment.
- Engage in professional learning and collegial collaboration to enhance continuous growth.

Unit 1: Understanding Teaching (Week 1 – 3)

1.1 T**he Nature of a Profession and Professionalism**

- Concept of a profession and professional

- Features distinguishing a profession from an occupation
- Professionalism in teaching vs Professionalization of teaching
- Comparative perspective: Teaching vs other professions

1.2 **From Industrial Models to Inquiry-Based Professionalism**

- Historical "industrial" metaphors of teaching (efficiency, control, compliance).
- Shift toward reflective, inquiry-based, and learning-centered professionalism.

1.3 **Dimensions of Teacher Professionalism**

- Specialized knowledge and training
- Professional code of conduct and ethical behavior
- Accountability, autonomy, and collegiality in professional practice
- Role of professional associations and accreditation bodies

1.4 **Developing Teacher Identity**

- Understanding how personal beliefs and values shape teacher identity.
- Influence of sociocultural and policy contexts on teacher professionalism
- Role of reflection and self-awareness in teacher identity formation
- Reflection on who am I becoming as a teacher

Unit 2: Models and Frameworks of Professional Ethics and Behaviors (Week 4-5)

2.1 Meaning and significance of professional ethics

2.2 **Teacher Behavior and Codes of Ethical Conduct**

- Ethical conduct towards students, practice and performance, parents and community, and colleagues and professionals
- Local and international codes (e.g., UNESCO, NACTE guidelines)

2.3 **Models and Frameworks of Ethical Behaviors**

- Rest's four-component model of moral behavior
- The four step ethical decision making framework (Empathy, Context, Reflect, Action)
- Reflective Decision Making
- Handlingethical dilemmas in classroom (e.g., grading, confidentiality, social media, equity)

Unit 3: Becoming an Effective Teacher (Week 6-8)

3.1 Understanding Teacher Effectiveness

- Redefining an effective teaching and effective teacher
- Components of teacher effectiveness

3.2 Personal and Professional Qualities of an Effective Teacher

- Attitude of teacher towards teaching profession
- Dressing and grooming as dimensions of professional image

- Personality traits of effective teachers (empathy, patience, self-control, optimism, humor, resilience, adaptability etc.).
- Influence of personality trait on teacher effectiveness

3.3 Social skills and Relationship Building

- Building positive relationships with various stakeholders
- Managing conflict and maintaining professionalism in relationships

3.4 Effective communication skills

- Verbal Communication
- Non-verbal communication (Types and classroom use)

3.5 The Evolving Roles of The Effective Teacher in the 21st Century

- Teacher as facilitator, researcher, change agent, moral agent, and life-long learner

Unit 4: The Professional Standards and Competencies for Teachers (9-11

4.1**Understanding Professional Standards**

- Concept and purpose of professional standards
- Global and national perspectives on teacher standards
- Usingofstandards for ensuring teacher quality and accountability

4.2 **Overview of the National Professional Standards for Teachers in Pakistan**

- Structure, domains and indicators

4.3 Applying standards in Practice to guide self-evaluation

4.4 **Linking standards to the teacher licensing, certification, and appraisal**

Unit 5: Issues and Challenges in Teaching Profession (12-13)

5.1**Challenges and Realities of Teacher Professionalism**

- Workload, stress and burnout
- Multilingual and multi-grade classroom
- Increased focus on teacher accountability
- Lack of support and resources
- High expectations of various stock holders from teachers
- Socio-economic status and public recognition

5.2**Professionalism in the Digital Age**

- Pressure to integrate technology
- Responsible use of digital platforms and resources

5.3 **Responding to Professional Challenges: Towards Growth and Development**

Unit 6: Sustaining Professionalism through Continuous Learning (14-1

6.1 **Definition and basic Concept of continuous Professional Development (CPD)**

- Need for Continuous Professional Learning and Development
- Principles of Professional Development

6.2 **Stages of Professional Development**

- Preservice Stage
- New Teacher Stage
- Experienced Teacher Stage

6.3 **Ways to Continue to Develop as a Professional**

- Conferences
- Workshops
- Online professional development platforms
- Professional Learning Communities (PLCs):
- Reflective Practice and Self-Evaluation Tools (Journals, portfolios, peer feedback, and lesson study).

6.4 **Building a Personal Professional Development Plan**

Suggested Readings

Beijaard, D., Meijer, P. C., & Verloop, N. (2004). Reconsidering research on teachers' professional identity. *Teaching and Teacher Education, 20*(2), 107–128. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tate.2003.07.001

Brookfield, S. D. (2017). *Becoming a critically reflective teacher* (2nd ed.). San Francisco, CA: Jossey-Bass.

Carr, D. (2000). *Professionalism and ethics in teaching*. London, England: Routledge.

Day, C. (1999). *Developing teachers: The challenges of lifelong learning*. London, England: Falmer Press.

Demirkasımoğlu, N. (2010). Defining "teacher professionalism" from different perspectives. *Procedia - Social and Behavioral Sciences, 9,* 2047–2051. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.sbspro.2010.12.444

Ehrich, L. C., Kimber, M., Millwater, J., & Cranston, N. (2011). Ethical dilemmas: A model to understand teacher practice. *Teachers and Teaching: Theory and Practice, 17*(2), 173–185. https://doi.org/10.1080/13540602.2011.539794

Guskey, T. R. (2000). *Evaluating professional development*. Thousand Oaks, CA: Corwin Press.

Hargreaves, A. (2000). Four ages of professionalism and professional learning. *Teachers and Teaching, 6*(2), 151–182. https://doi.org/10.1080/713698714

Hurst, B., & Reding, G. (2009). *Professionalism in teaching.* Upper Saddle River, NJ: Pearson Education.

Icka, E., & Kochoska, J. (2024). The influence of teachers as an ethical model on students' development. *International Journal of Education Teacher, 27,* 99–107.

Suarez, V., & McGrath, J. (2022). *Teacher professional identity: How to develop and support it in times of change.* (OECD Education Working Papers, No. 267). Paris, France: OECD Publishing. https://doi.org/10.1787/b19f5af7-en

Villegas-Reimers, E. (2003). *Teacher professional development: An international review of the literature.* Paris, France: UNESCO International Institute for Educational Planning (IIEP).